

Company Performance Investigation

Prepared for the CEO · 18-Month Sales Review

Situation Summary

The business has experienced a decline in performance across 30 stores over the past 18 months. Sales, transaction volumes, and loyalty programme engagement have all weakened, although levels defer across stores and product categories. This brief defines three business questions that will guide the diagnostic analysis and the decisions each question unlocks.

Three Key Business Questions

Q1 Which stores are driving the most revenue loss, and what do they have in common?

Matters because: Identifying the worst-performing stores — and shared traits — tells leadership where to intervene and whether problems are local or structural.

Q2 Which products have seen the steepest sales decline, and when did the drop begin?

Matters because: Pinpointing where and when sales fell helps separate a pricing or range issue from an external market shift — and prioritises which categories need action.

Q3 How has loyalty programme engagement changed, and are active members spending less per visit than they did 12 months ago?

Matters because: Drop in spending among loyal customers is an early warning sign of eroding brand value — and these are the customers most worth retaining.

Decisions These Questions Inform

- Which stores to prioritise for operational review or closure.
- Where to reduce or reallocate product range investment.
- How to redesign the loyalty programme to improve customer retention.

Available Data

- **Store performance** — 18 months, 30 stores
- **Product sales** — category and product level
- **Customer transactions** — purchase size, frequency
- **Loyalty programme** — enrolment, redemption, spend per member.

THE AI PROMPT

ROLE: Act as a senior retail data analyst with over 8 years of experience. **CONTEXT:** I have an 18-month sales dataset for a retail company that operates 30 stores. This company has experienced declining performance over the last 18 months. The dataset covers; store performance, product sales, customer transactions, and loyalty programme activity. **TASK:** To help investigate the causes and identify opportunities for improvement, generate a one-page Stakeholder Brief for the CEO. **FORMAT:** The brief must include: Situation Summary, Three Key Business Questions, Decisions These Questions Will Inform, and Description of Available Data. **CONSTRAINTS:** Questions must be specific, measurable and actionable. No vague questions. No statistics jargon. The stakeholders brief must not exceed 250 words **EXAMPLE:** 1. What is the sales performance per store for the last 6 months? — Matters because: this will help the CEO focus on how to improve performance for struggling stores

SHORT REFLECTION

I structured my prompt using the 6-part prompt framework (RCTFCE) in a way that it captured the entire scenario and provided the best questions that provided measurable and actionable solutions. I designed my prompt to follow the 3 sections and stated in the assignment brief while also ensuring that all aspects of the provided dataset are adequately utilized.